



AIIMS TRAINS STUDENTS TO TAKE LEADERSHIP IN HEALTHCARE

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## COVER STORY

INDIA'S **TOP 10** COLLEGES THE INDIA TODAY-NIELSEN SURVEY

# MEDICINE

Emphasis on an internal culture of excellence and advanced medical technology has won AIIMS the top slot again this year, while there has been a major reshuffle in the middle ranks

By Damayanti Datta

Right outside the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), someone has planted a foot-long god. You can't tell which but a deity no less, going by the fresh garland of flowers and the bowl of loose change. A little prayer of hope to get you going. Inside, a different type of religion resides. With 453 faculty and 1,200-plus junior doctors handling 15,28,238 outpatients, 83,852 admissions and 77,631 surgeries, while teaching 1,661 students, investigating 381 projects and publishing 1,424 scholarly papers last year—one can say work is worship at India's best medical institution.

With such startling statistics, AIIMS once again grabbed the top slot in the INDIA TODAY survey of academic excellence in medicine, jumping ahead of competitors by a significant 20.6 points. The Christian Medical College (CMC), Vellore, and the Armed Forces Medical College (AFMC), Pune—no strangers to rankings—fought neck-to-



| 2009  |                                      | 2008 | 2007 |
|-------|--------------------------------------|------|------|
| >> 1  | AIIMS, Delhi                         | 1    | 1    |
| >> 2  | Christian Medical College, Vellore   | 2    | 3    |
| >> 3  | Armed Forces Medical College, Pune   | 3    | 2    |
| >> 4  | JIPMER, Puducherry                   | 4    | 4    |
| >> 5  | Maulana Azad Medical College, Delhi  | 5    | 7    |
| ^ 6   | Madras Medical College, Chennai      | 8    | 10   |
| ∇ 7   | Grant Medical College, Mumbai        | 6    | 8    |
| ^ 8   | Seth GS Medical College, Mumbai      | 9    | 16   |
| ∇ 9   | Kasturba Medical College, Manipal    | 7    | 5    |
| >> 10 | Lady Hardinge Medical College, Delhi | 10   | 6    |

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked. Faculties were not considered.